FROM ZERO TO FUNDED:

Your Playbook for Passing Prop Firm Challenges



Sam Sidney in partnership with FundedNext

From Zero to Funded: Your Playbook for Passing Prop Firm Challenges:

By Sam Sidney X FundedNext

Introduction

If you've ever felt like you were stuck trading small accounts, or constantly second-guessing your setups, I get it. I've been there too.

It's frustrating to know how much potential you have, but not have the capital or the structure to unlock it. That's exactly why I partnered with FundedNext—because they offer real traders like you and me the chance to scale without risking massive amounts of personal capital.

But here's the truth:
Getting funded is not about luck.
It's about structure, mindset, and confidence in your approach.

This guide will walk you through everything from building your foundation, to understanding the realities of prop firms, to managing risk like a pro.

By the time you finish, you'll know exactly what to focus on, and you'll feel ready to take the next step.

Whether that's grabbing your first $50K challenge or scaling up to a six-figure account.

Want to gain access to: Live trading tips, daily reminders, valuable mindset shifts, accountability and exclusive offers **tap here to join my free telegram.**

Let's begin...

Step 1: Learn What Matters (And Ignore the Noise)

Before you even think about taking a challenge, you need to get your foundations right.

Trading isn't about how many hours you study or how many indicators you stack on a chart. It's about knowing how the market moves, how to spot key moments of opportunity, and how to manage your risk when they come.

Here are the essential concepts you should focus on:

- Market Structure: Understand how trends form, reverse, and continue.
- Risk Management: The most overlooked skill that separates professionals from gamblers.
- Candlestick Patterns: Learn how price action reveals intent.
- Sweeps & Displacements: These show signs of manipulation and key entries.
- Supply & Demand: Learn where price is likely to react.
- Fair Value Gaps: Identify inefficiencies in price for high-probability setups.
- Order Types: Know when to use limit, market, and stop orders.
- Prop Firm Capital: Understand the opportunity it presents.
- Trading Psychology: Learn how to stay emotionally consistent under pressure.

This isn't a checklist to rush through. It's a core curriculum. Mastering these will give you the ability to spot opportunity, structure trades, and stay calm under pressure. Ignore everything else.

Step 2: Build Your Trading Plan

If you can't clearly explain your system in 2 minutes, you don't have one. A good trading plan is simple and repeatable:

Once you've built some foundational knowledge, it's time to make it real. Trading isn't just about theory, it's about having a system you trust.

Your plan should include:

- Clear Goals: Why are you trading? What would success look like for you?
- One Market Focus: Master one pair or asset class before branching out.
- Defined Edge: Know exactly what you're looking for when you enter a trade.
- Entry, Exit, and Risk Rules: Make your decisions ahead of time, not in the moment.
- Daily Routine: Build a structure so trading becomes consistent and repeatable.

This is your framework. If you want a firm to give you $100K, you better be able to prove that you've got a process.

Step 3: Backtest It With Purpose

Confidence doesn't come from "feeling good" it comes from seeing data.

You can't expect to trust your system in live conditions if you've never seen it work consistently. That's where backtesting comes in.

Here's how to do it right:

- Use TradingView's replay mode
- Simulate trading a $10K account
- Take at least 200 trades
- Log everything: entry, exit, stop loss, R/R, win or loss
- Aim for a +25% return

More important than the win rate is your consistency.

Backtesting trains your discipline and reveals flaws in your strategy before they cost you real money.

Step 4: Journal Like It's Your Job

Journaling isn't optional, it's essential.

This is how you track your progress, identify your bad habits, and refine your edge over time.

What to include:

- Trade screenshots (entry + exit)
- Position size and outcome
- Reason for the trade
- Emotions you felt during the setup and management
- Lessons learned

Review your journal weekly.

Look for patterns. Make adjustments. This is where you build an edge.

Step 5: Get Funded and Scale

Let's talk about why prop firms, especially FundedNext are one of the best tools for serious traders:

- You're not risking your own capital
- You get access to large accounts ($50K–$300K+)
- You can scale up your income very quickly
- You learn to trade with discipline, because rules are strict

Here's what most people get wrong: they see failing a challenge as a loss.

But the reality is this: if you take a $50K challenge that costs you $250, and you pass it and receive even one payout of $1,000, you've already 4x'd your money. And if you keep the account funded, you're now in a position to earn real monthly income you can us to escape the rat race.

If you fail the challenge, it's still a cost of education. Just make sure you learn from it.

→ ***Click here to start your challenge with FundedNext***

Part 2: Key Prop Firm Tips Most People Overlook

1. Don't Treat It Like a Lottery

Prop firms aren't a shortcut to wealth, they're tools to help you scale. Think of the challenge fee like an investment into your business. You're paying to prove yourself.

If you fail a challenge, don't spiral. Learn from it, adjust, and try again.

2. Start With a 50K Account

It's the sweet spot:

Low enough to be affordable, high enough to make meaningful payouts.

It also reduces pressure and makes it easier to manage risk while you build your edge.

3. Keep a Spreadsheet

Track everything:

- Challenge costs

- Passed vs. failed
- Total ROI
- Payouts received

This helps you stay objective.

If you treat your prop firm journey like a business, you'll start seeing business-level results.

4. Know Your 'Why'

Are you:

- Trying to build long-term capital?
- Supplementing income to go full time?
- Practicing for managing your own large account?

Each goal requires a slightly different approach.

Define it, and build backwards from there.

5. Understand Scaling

Once you pass one account and build a buffer (aim for 3–5%), that becomes your floor.

Never dip below it. Use payouts to buy more challenges, scale to bigger accounts, and reduce personal financial risk. That's how the pros do it.

6. Track Tax & Expenses

If you have a registered business, your challenge fees may be tax deductible.

Speak with your accountant and track everything. Again—this is a business.

→ ***Start Scaling With FundedNext Now***

Part 3: A Practical Risk Management Plan

Risk management isn't just "setting a stop-loss."

It's how you stay in the game long enough to win.

Here's a simple system to follow during challenges:

Your Daily Rules:

- Max Risk/Trade: 0.5–1%
- Max Trades/Day: 2–3
- Daily Drawdown Rule: If you lose 2 trades, stop for the day
- No Revenge Trading: Ever
- Log everything (win or lose)

Your Setup Criteria:

Only enter when:

- The market aligns with your bias
- You're trading during your optimal session/time
- Risk-to-reward is at least 1:2
- You're emotionally neutral, not chasing or forcing

Managing the Challenge:

- Buffer: Once you pass, build a 3–5% buffer before scaling risk
- Consistency > Size: Keep risk flat until you hit your first payout
- Withdraw wisely: Take profits, reinvest in new challenges/accounts
- Avoid pressure: Smaller targets = better execution

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Aggressive Risk Plan (Advanced Traders Only)

This approach is for consistently profitable traders who:

- Have a proven system with 6+ months of data
- Are emotionally disciplined
- Are looking to speed up challenge passing

Key Notes:

- Only use this if you understand the risk
- Always follow your challenge's daily drawdown and max loss rules
- This is not gambling—it's a structured, intentional approach

Aggressive Plan Guidelines:

- Risk/Trade: 1.5%–2% max
- Max Risk/Day: 3% (Depending on firm)
- Take only A+ setups
- Use break-even stops and partials to protect open profit

Example Strategy:

- Pass Phase 1 in 7–10 trades
- Phase 2: Drop back to 1% risk per trade
- Add buffer before increasing size again

Disclaimer: This plan is not for beginners or those emotionally reactive to drawdowns. Only implement if you've already proven your edge and can remain consistent under pressure.

→ ***Start Your Next Challenge With FundedNext***

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- Live trading tips and reminders
- Mindset shifts and accountability
- Exclusive offers and support

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Final Words

The road to consistent income through prop firms doesn't start with luck, it starts with a clear plan and the right partner.

That's why I recommend FundedNext.

They're not just another prop firm, they're setting the standard for what real traders need to succeed:

- Up to $300K in funding
- 15% profit share during the challenge
- Up to 95% profit split once funded
- No time limit on challenges
- Get paid in 24 hours or they send you $1,000
- Available in 195+ countries
- Free resets, top-ups, and 24/7 support
- Rated 4.6★ on Trustpilot with over 34,000+ reviews
- Trade Forex, Futures, or CFDs. Your edge, your way

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If you've read this far, you already know what to do next.

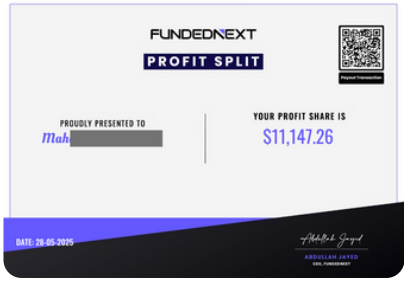
Start with your first challenge account, build your buffer, and scale smart.

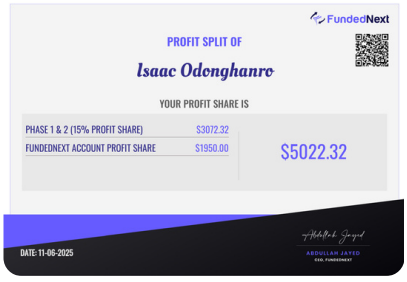
→ ***Click here to get funded with FundedNext, and start trading today.***

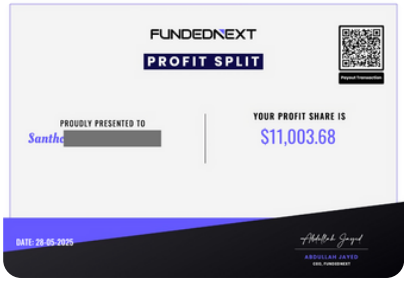
You've got the blueprint. Now it's time to take action.

- Sam Sidney

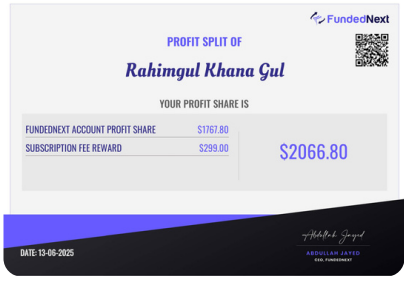
PS: Check out some of the results other traders are getting from the Fundednext



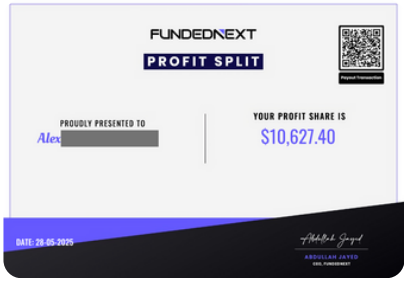


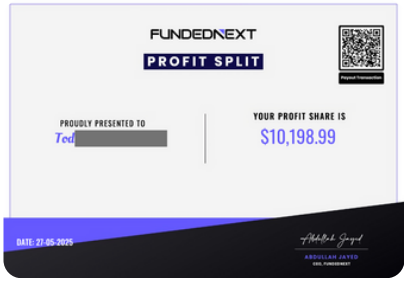


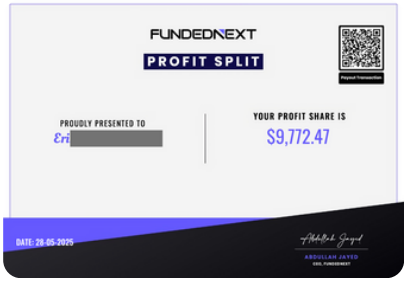












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